Voice and Indic language usage in India: an opportunity for trusted AI dictation

With India's huge population of Indic-language speakers and widespread use of voice commands, there is an opportunity for trusted multilingual dictation.

140M

VOICE COMMAND USERS

Used voice-based commands to access the internet in 2024.

870M

INDIC-LANGUAGE INTERNET USERS

Accessed the internet in Indic languages in 2024.

55%

RURAL SHARE OF VOICE COMMAND USERS

Of India's voice command users, 55% came from rural areas.

>40%

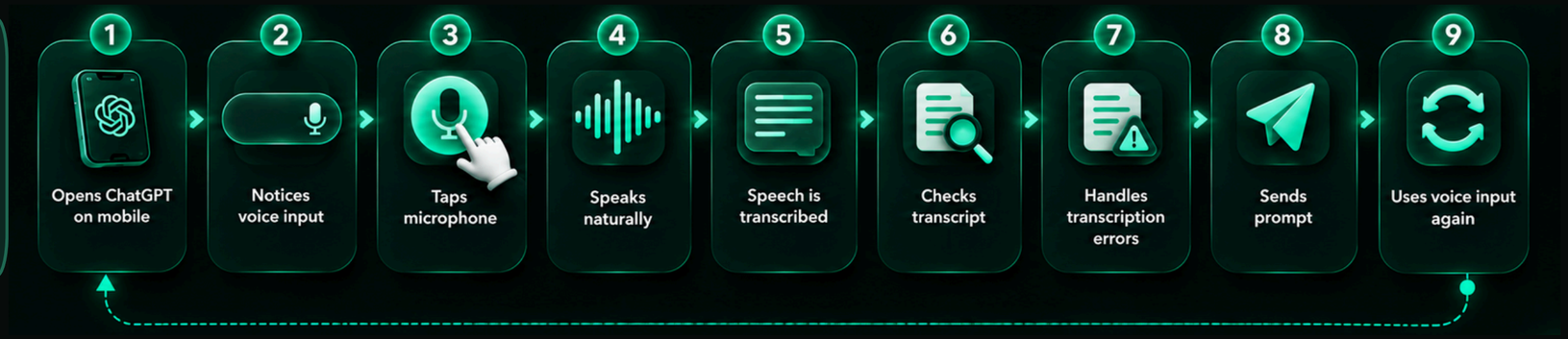
VOICE USE IN GEMINI

Over 40% of Gemini's Indian-language users already rely on voice interactions.

WHAT IT MEANS FOR CHATGPT:

Product Hypothesis:

We believe people will use dictation with ChatGPT more often when it accurately captures mixed-language speech and makes errors easy to identify.



APPLICATION CONTEXT TARGET

A mobile user speaks naturally in a local language . . .

…but uses English work terms such as "**Fire NOC**" because that is how the term is used at work.

Benchmark: **WhatsApp** builds familiarity with voice; **Google Assistant** sets expectations for speed. **ChatGPT** users need confidence that mixed-language transcripts preserve their meaning and critical terms.

RESEARCH SEQUENCE

Assumption → User Testing → Observed Evidence → Problem Identification → Product Outcome → KPI Tree

Five participants each spoke the same mixed-language *work prompt—"Aji shaam ko please amar Fire NOC report-ta English-e summarize kori diba."—in* ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity, producing 15 tests. We checked whether each transcript preserved the intended meaning, appeared in the participant's preferred script and retained "Fire NOC" correctly.

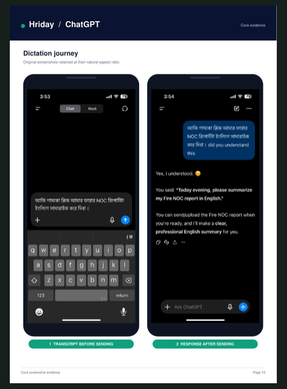
Sources: IAMAI–Kantar, Internet in India 2024, pp. 13 and 15; Google for India 2024

It was easy to start dictating BUT the real friction was the transcript.

Primary research: 15 app tests observed (5 participants × 3 apps × same mixed-language work task).

Participants: Apoorba, Rohan, Javed, Tutu and Hriday.

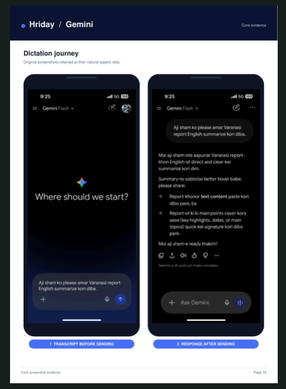
CHATGPT



Overall preferred by 4/5 participants

"Fire NOC" retained exactly in 0/5 tests

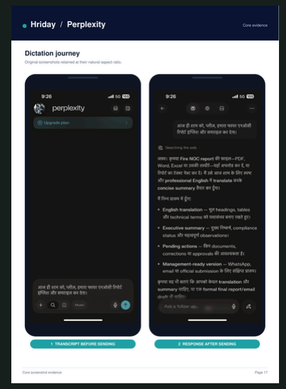
GEMINI



Rated easiest for voice input by 3/5 participants

In one test, "Fire NOC" became "Varanasi"

PERPLEXITY



Meaning preserved in 4/5 tests

Preferred script frequently mismatched

PILOT RESULTS — 15 TESTS

15/15
Participants easily found the microphone and started dictating.

12/15
The user's intended meaning was retained.

1/15
Only Javed's Gemini test wrote "Fire NOC" correctly.

3/15
The transcript appeared in the participant's preferred script.

SO WHAT?

Starting dictation was easy in all 15 tests because participants could find the microphone button. The actual issue came after they spoke. In some tests, important words changed, the transcript came in a different script, or users would have to make too many corrections. This can reduce their trust and make them go back to typing.

This was a small test with five participants, so it only shows us a direction and does not represent every user in India.

- **People preferred ChatGPT overall, but more people found Gemini easier for voice input.**
- **Gemini wrote "Fire NOC" correctly for Javed but changed it to "Varanasi" for Hriday.**
- **Perplexity understood the meaning in most tests but often wrote the transcript in a script that the participant did not prefer.**

Evidence: • User-testing screenshot record (15 tests) • OpenAI Dictation FAQ

Increase voice usage through successful dictation and repeat use

People use voice technology more when they can finish typing by talking, trust what gets written down, fix errors, and then decide to use it again.

GUARDRAILS

- **Incorrect-Send Rate: How many prompts were submitted with important errors?**
- **Dictation Abandonment Rate: Did users start but leave without sending?**
- **Median Correction Time: How long did correction usually take?**
- **Voice Latency: How long did the transcript take to appear?**



BUSINESS OUTCOME

Increase engagement with ChatGPT mobile in India

Dictation reduces typing effort and improves access for multilingual mobile users.

PRODUCT OUTCOME

Increase successful and repeat use of dictation

North Star Metric: Users who successfully completed at least two voice tasks during the week.
All funnel rates are measured weekly

Users with dictation access × Activation Rate × Successful Voice Task Rate × Weekly Repeat Rate

Successful Voice Task Rate:
Users who submitted a dictated prompt and received a satisfactory reply ÷ Users who started dictation × 100

Did users submit the dictated prompt and receive a reply that matched what they intended to ask?

ADOPTION

Did users try dictation?

Activation rate

Users who started Dictation ÷ Users with Dictation access × 100

RELIABILITY

Was the first transcript correct and usable?

First-Transcript Success Rate

Users whose first transcript was correct and usable ÷ Users who started dictation × 100

RECOVERY

Could users correct an incorrect transcript?

Correction success rate

Users who corrected an inaccurate transcript and submitted ÷ Users who received an inaccurate transcript × 100

REPEAT USE

Did successful users use it again that week?

Weekly Repeat Rate

Users who successfully completed at least two voice tasks during the week ÷ Users who successfully completed at least one voice task during the week × 100

SUPPORTING

Critical-term retention rate

Did ChatGPT correctly retain important English terms such as “Fire NOC”?

= Correctly retained critical terms ÷ Critical terms spoken × 100

Preferred-script match

Did ChatGPT write the transcript in the script the user preferred?

= Transcripts in the user’s preferred script ÷ Completed transcripts × 100

Meaning-Preservation Rate

Did the ChatGPT transcript retain what the user actually meant?

= Transcripts preserving the intended meaning ÷ Completed transcripts × 100

Proposed metrics: • Research workbook (n=5) • Proposed KPI baselines/targets require product analytics • OpenAI: Dictation returns editable text before sending